

Bruce Nduko

Co-Founder & CTO, Tija Labs · Founder-Engineer · BSc Computer Science

Thika, Kiambu County, Kenya | brucenduko@tijalabs.com | +254 116 602 640 | tijalabs.com

PROFILE

Founder-engineer building AI-powered productivity tools for young, urban Africans and Kenya's informal economy. Co-founded Tija Labs and lead its product and engineering end to end: web and Android apps, payments, infrastructure, security and deployment. Ship fast using AI-assisted engineering workflows while studying Computer Science full-time.

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer — Tija Labs Kenya · Present

AI product lab building productivity apps for young, urban Africans. "Turn Time Into Value."

- Own product, engineering and infrastructure across the company's portfolio; co-lead the company with co-founder Jeremiah Rioba (People & Operations).
- Shipped multiple live products across web and Android, including StudySphere, Allama and LeverageX (Google Play).
- Built a complete subscription invoicing and billing system (Node.js/Express, SQLite, Pesapal API v3, PDF invoicing, automated email); selected Pesapal after evaluating gateway availability in Kenya.
- Built and deployed the company website (tijalabs.com) with custom DNS, contact-form email delivery and blog; set up company email, LinkedIn page, WhatsApp Business and brand identity.

SELECTED PROJECTS

StudySphere Live · Web + Android studysphere.it.com

Student productivity platform with an AI assistant (Sage), autopilot study planner, focus timer and exam mode. Deployed on Vercel with custom domain.

Allama — Productivity Passport Live · Web allama-theta.vercel.app

Turns M-Pesa SMS, job photos and voice notes into verifiable work records for informal-economy workers. Led build, security hardening and environment configuration before production deployment.

LeverageX Live · Google Play [Google Play](https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.leverage)

Productivity and goal-tracking Android app. Took the app through Play Console closed testing to production access.

Hali In development · Nairobi alpha

Venue discovery and experience platform with Taste DNA personalization and live venue intelligence (Hali Pulse). Authored a 21-section product requirements document.

Ledger In development

Chat-first AI career copilot.

Dishi In development

Meal-decision app that recommends what to eat based on a user's favourite meals, allergies and food preferences.

HACKATHONS

- **Build with Gemini XPRIZE** (2026) — Submitted 10 original productivity product concepts, including Stakes, Sema Kazi, Alongside, Reflow and Productivity Passport.
- **Qwen Cloud Hackathon** (2026) — Produced build specs for Productivity Passport, an SHA Claims Pre-Check Agent and a Skill Verification Agent targeting Kenya's informal economy.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Computer Science — Zetech University Expected 2029

Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented Programming (C++), Computer Vision, Probability & Statistics, Python, Machine Learning Fundamentals.

AI Programming with Python Nanodegree — Udacity In progress

Microsoft AI-901: Azure AI Fundamentals In progress

SKILLS

Languages	Python, JavaScript / TypeScript, C++, SQL
Engineering	Node.js, Express, SQLite, REST APIs, payments integration (Pesapal), PDF & email automation
Mobile & Web	Android app publishing (Google Play Console), web platforms, responsive sites
Infra & Security	Vercel, GitHub Pages, DNS & domains, secrets management, security hardening, Kali Linux
AI	LLM-powered features, ML fundamentals, computer vision, AI-assisted development (Claude, Codex)
Product	PRDs, product concepting, engineering hiring specs, brand identity